

# Multitasking machines

The more tasks a computer can handle at once, the faster it can complete them all. The first computers could only handle one task, but these days a laptop or cellphone can perform thousands of separate tasks, called processes, at the same time.

**! WOW!**

The **heaviest computer ever** was the **SAGE system**, at **250 tons (226.8 m tons)**.

## Z3

The Z3, built in Germany, was the world's first programmable computer. Older computers needed to be rewired to run new programs, but the Z3 stored its programs on paper tape. It was destroyed by bombs during World War II.

### FACT FILE

» **When:** 1941

» **Weight:** 1 ton (0.9 m tons)

» **Fun fact:** The German government refused to help improve the Z3. They felt computers were not important to the war.

